

1846. Maximum Element After Decreasing and Rearranging

Difficulty: Medium

Link: <https://leetcode.com/problems/maximum-element-after-decreasing-and-rearranging/?envType=daily-question&envId=2026-06-28>

Generated at: 2026-07-01 00:07:57

Problem:

You are given an array of positive integers `arr`. Perform some operations (possibly none) on `arr` so that it satisfies these conditions:

- The value of the **first** element in `arr` must be `1`.
- The absolute difference between any 2 adjacent elements must be **less than or equal to** `1`. In other words, $\text{abs}(\text{arr}[i] - \text{arr}[i - 1]) \leq 1$ for each `i` where $1 \leq i < \text{arr.length}$ (**0-indexed**). $\text{abs}(x)$ is the absolute value of `x`.

There are 2 types of operations that you can perform any number of times:

- **Decrease** the value of any element of `arr` to a **smaller positive integer**.
- **Rearrange** the elements of `arr` to be in any order.

Return the **maximum** possible value of an element in `arr` after performing the operations to satisfy the conditions.

Example 1:

Input: `arr = [2,2,1,2,1]`

Output: `2`

Explanation:

We can satisfy the conditions by rearranging `arr` so it becomes `[1,2,2,2,1]` .

The largest element in `arr` is 2.

Example 2:

Input: `arr = [100,1,1000]`

Output: 3

Explanation:

One possible way to satisfy the conditions is by doing the following:

1. Rearrange `arr` so it becomes `[1,100,1000]` .
2. Decrease the value of the second element to 2.
3. Decrease the value of the third element to 3.

Now `arr = [1,2,3]` , which satisfies the conditions.

The largest element in `arr` is 3.

Example 3:

Input: `arr = [1,2,3,4,5]`

Output: 5

Explanation: The array already satisfies the conditions, and the largest element is 5.

Constraints:

- `1 <= arr.length <= 105`
- `1 <= arr[i] <= 109`